SPECULA | Blinded reviewer instructions

Unpopulated protocol template - 11 November 2026

Before review

An evaluation coordinator must validate the evidence/labels, freeze the case subset and record corpus hashes before review. Assign randomized run aliases that conceal the producing system, ablation condition and model. Keep the alias key, original labels, answer keys and benchmark filenames evaluator-only. Reviewers must not receive other reviewers' judgments before submitting their own.

Unit of judgment

Review every atomic factual claim separately. Link each judgment to case-local evidence and an evidence identifier. Record claim support as supported, partially supported, unsupported or unverifiable. Use unverifiable when evidence or annotation is insufficient; do not convert missing data to a negative label. A syntactically valid citation does not prove claim support.

Additional judgments

Assess citation validity separately from semantic support. Use verified outcomes and timestamp uncertainty; chronological order alone is not causation. Record critical-evidence and relationship judgments only where independent sources support them. Fixture/synthetic provenance does not prove benignness, maliciousness or successful execution.

Independence and adjudication

Use at least two independent forensic-literate reviewers for scored claim-support judgments. Preserve each original judgment and evidence reference before discussion. Store any adjudicated judgment in a separate field, with rationale, without replacing originals. Record blinding breaks, conflicts, missing evidence and ambiguous cases. Calculate reviewer agreement only after collecting independent ratings.

Reporting

Do not fill templates with guessed truth or scores. Freeze metric denominators and case-level uncertainty analysis before comparing systems. Retain failed runs and timeouts. Separate compute time from analyst wait. NIST Hacking Case dependent runs remain pending while the image is deferred. This template does not certify independent annotation or completed experiments.